

HarborScout AI

Micro autonomous surface vessels for dangerous maritime missions



Investor pitch deck

Working name and assumptions are editable

Maritime autonomy is moving from demo theater to procurement pressure.

23+

Unmanned systems tested by Navy Task Force 59

60k+

Unmanned operating hours reported across exercises

2025

USCG creates robotics and autonomous systems PEO

\$9.25B

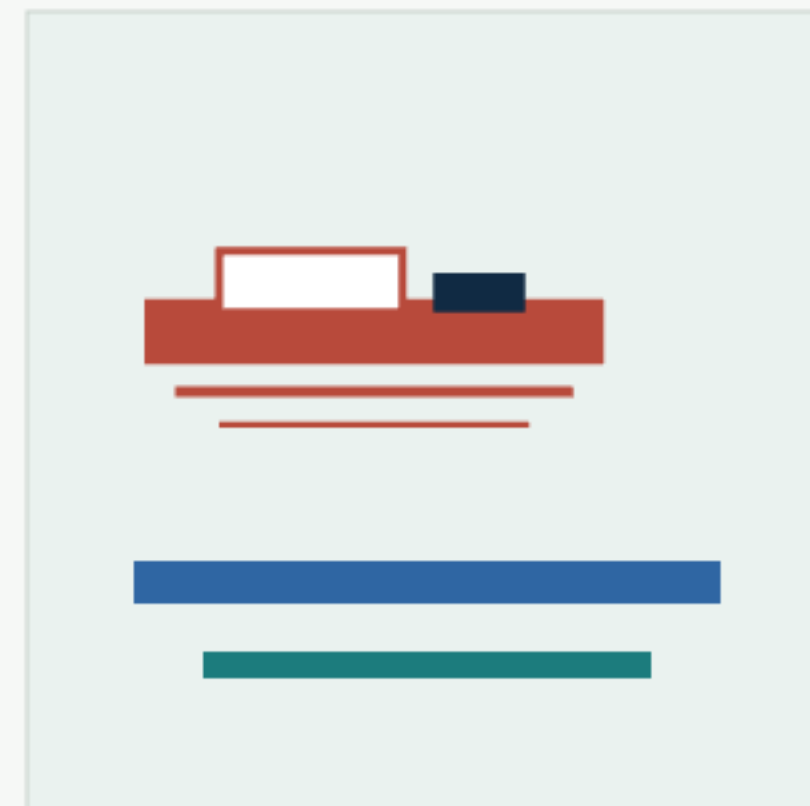
Reported Saronic valuation after Series D

The opportunity is not another generic boat. It is a mission-specific, low-cost sensing platform that gets trusted in real water before incumbents can bundle the workflow.

Sources: YC seed deck template; EIR memo 2026-05-26; Navy, USCG, Saronic, Saildrone, HavocAI, MARTAC, Textron, Hydronalix, MarketsandMarkets, Fortune Business Insights.

The most dangerous maritime searches still put people and expensive assets in harm's way.

- Search and rescue needs fast coverage when conditions are bad and minutes matter.
- Mine-like object and underwater debris detection is slow, risky, and sensor-heavy.
- Ports, bridges, rivers, and harbors need persistent domain awareness without crewing every patrol.
- Defense and public-safety teams face budget, staffing, and launch/recovery constraints.



Crewed boats, helicopters, divers, and fixed sensors are too scarce or too slow for the full mission load.

Existing options force a tradeoff between size, cost, persistence, and safety.

Crewed small boats

Flexible but expensive, crew-constrained, and exposed to threat or weather.

Aerial drones

Fast to deploy but limited by endurance, payload, weather, and surface/underwater sensing.

Large USVs

Capable but expensive, harder to launch, and often overkill for harbor-scale missions.

Fixed sensors

Persistent but static, blind outside coverage zones, and slow to redeploy.

HarborScout's wedge: small enough to deploy frequently, smart enough to classify mission objects, cheap enough to put where crewed assets cannot wait.

A very small autonomous surface vessel built around mission sensing, not boat novelty.



1

Autonomous hull

Shore, truck, small boat, or cutter deployable

2

Mission payload

Optical, thermal, AIS, sonar, or other sensor kit

3

Edge AI

Object detection, classification, route planning, alerting

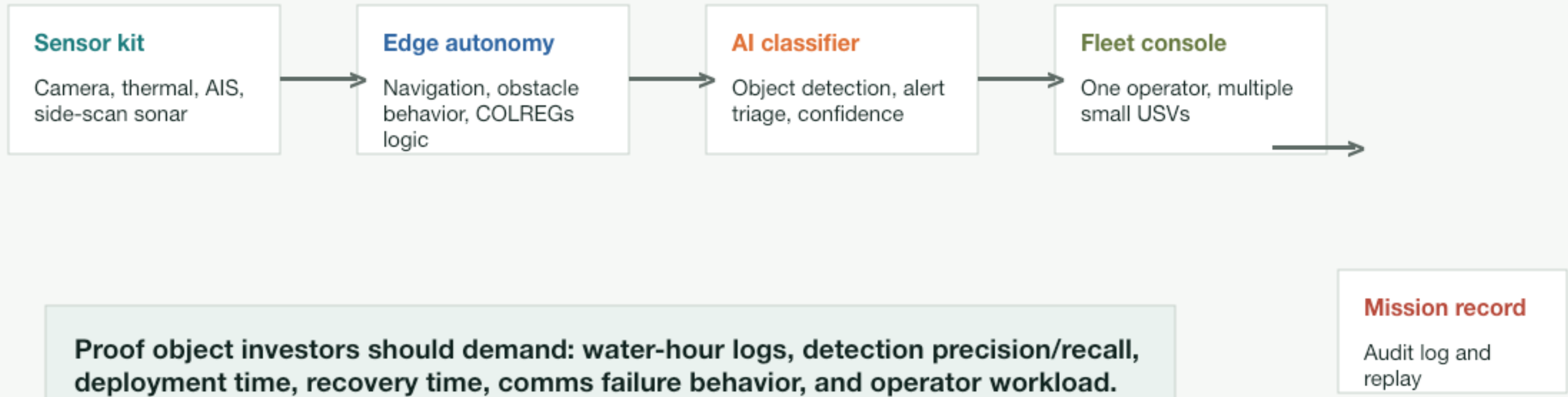
4

Operator console

Supervise multiple craft with clear override logic

First product goal: find, classify, and report mission objects in littoral water with less human exposure and lower cost per search hour.

The defensible product is the mission loop: sense, decide, coordinate, and prove.



Start non-kinetic: object detection and search workflows create trust faster than weaponized use cases.

Coast Guard / SAR

Locate person-sized targets, debris, or hazards while expanding surface coverage.

Harbor security

Persistent patrol around ports, bridges, vessels, restricted zones, and event perimeters.

Mine-like object survey

Shallow-water detection and classification before any dangerous neutralization mission.

The beachhead should be a measurable mission with a fast pilot path, not a broad claim that it can do every maritime job.

Market reports understate the timing signal: buyers are moving because missions are changing.



MarketsandMarkets directional USV estimate

Fortune Business Insights broader USV estimate

Better lens: budgets for maritime domain awareness, mine countermeasures, port security, search and rescue, and unmanned fleet experimentation.

The space is crowded, so the deck must sell a wedge rather than a category.

Company	Main angle	Why it matters
Saronic	Defense-first ASVs	Well-funded production scale
Saildrone	Long-endurance MDA	Fleet data and operating history
HavocAI	Collaborative USV autonomy	Small-to-medium attritable systems
MARTAC	Man-portable USVs	Defense and SOF mission breadth
Textron	Program USV / MCM	Prime scale and towing payload
Hydronalix	SAR / small rescue USV	First-responder footprint

Positioning gap to test: smaller than defense ASVs, more mission-capable than first-responder rescue craft, cheaper and faster to pilot than prime-led systems.

Hardware opens the door; recurring software, support, and mission services make the business.

Hardware sale

USV, payload kit, chargers, spares, field kit

Gross margin improves with production discipline

Software + support

Autonomy, mission planning, classification, logs, fleet console

Recurring margin and expansion path

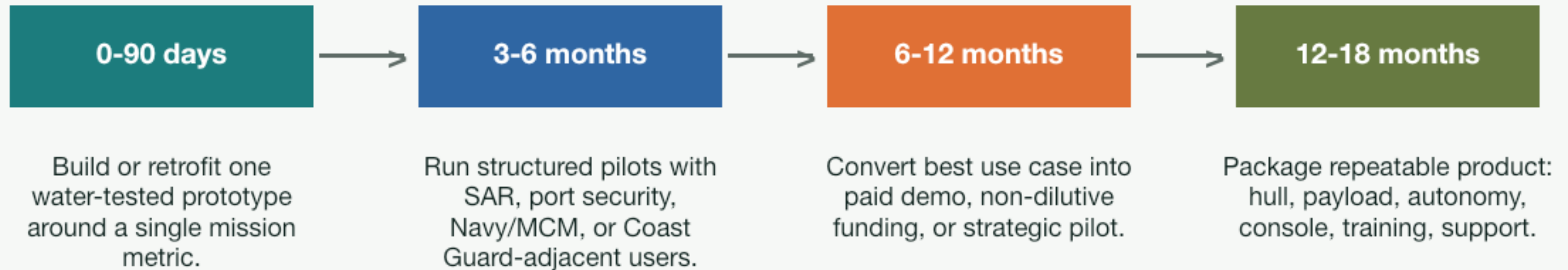
Mission service

Contractor-owned / operated search, survey, MDA, or inspection

Faster early revenue where buyers lack operators

North-star unit metric: lower cost per search hour, square mile covered, or confirmed object than crewed boats, aerial drones, and existing USVs.

Win trust through sponsored demos, not slideware.



Avoid starting with a weaponized sea bomber pitch. Start with sensing, safety, survey, and command workflows that buyers can test legally and quickly.

No traction has been provided yet, so the seed story should sell the next proof points explicitly.

Field demo

Autonomous waypoint mission, obstacle behavior, and recovery in real water.

Detection data

Precision / recall on person-sized, debris-like, or mine-like objects.

Buyer pull

15-25 structured interviews and 2-3 letters of support or demo sponsors.

Cost proof

Measured deployment time, operator load, and cost per search hour.

Investor posture: this is a strong pre-seed concept only after water-hour evidence and buyer-discovery signal exist.

The founding team must credibly combine maritime robotics, field operations, and defense acquisition.

Autonomy / perception

Edge AI, sensor fusion, navigation, low-bandwidth behavior

Marine hardware

Saltwater ruggedization, propulsion, power, launch/recovery

Mission operator

Coast Guard, Navy, SAR, port security, or MCM domain experience

Defense GTM

SBIR/OTA, pilots, primes, cybersecurity, sustainment

Editable placeholder: add founder bios, advisors, military/maritime credentials, prior exits, patents, and field-test history here.

Assumed pre-seed ask: \$1.5M to prove a narrow mission wedge in real water.

\$1.5M

Pre-seed target assumption;
replace with final raise amount

18 mo

Runway to field demo, buyer
proof, and seed-ready metrics

3 pilots

Target sponsored demos
across SAR, port, or defense
users

1 wedge

Pick one mission before scaling
into adjacent applications

45%



engineering, autonomy, and sensor integration

25%



prototype build, spares, field testing, and reliability

20%



pilot operations, compliance, cybersecurity, and support

10%



defense GTM, advisor network, and admin

Defense, Navy, and mine-countermeasure applications

MISSION LANES

MCM / mine-like object survey

Survey shallow grids, classify contacts, reduce diver and crew exposure.

Harbor and force protection

Patrol restricted water, detect vessels, swimmers, debris, or anomalies.

Attritable fleet scout

Low-cost forward sensing node for distributed maritime operations.

Range and training support

Recoverable target, telemetry, safety, and object-detection platform.

Key diligence gate: prove the small form factor can carry enough sensor, power, compute, and communications for the selected defense mission.

Coast Guard, SAR, and public-safety applications

FASTEST TRUST PATH

Search and rescue

Launch quickly, search grid, flag person-sized targets, stream location to incident command.

Maritime domain awareness

Support patrol and monitoring without crewing another surface asset.

Flood and disaster response

Operate where roads, bridges, and launch points are compromised.

Port and bridge security

Patrol high-value infrastructure and create a replayable mission record.

Why this appendix matters: SAR and public-safety use cases may be less capital-rich than defense, but they can produce faster field evidence and mission credibility.

Investor and strategic target map

Defense-tech VC

Shield, Scout, 8VC, a16z American Dynamism, Outlander, Veteran Fund, Decisive Point, New North

Maritime / robotics

Caffeinated, Lux, Konvoy, DNS, Techstars, S2G, Energy Innovation Capital, TechNexus

Strategic arms

Lockheed Martin Ventures, RTX Ventures, Boeing / AEI HorizonX, Kongsberg Innovation, HII channels

Potential advisors

TF59 alumni, USCG RAS context, Navy MCM/EOD experts, defense GTM operators, SAR leaders

Outreach rule: lead with the mission wedge and proof plan; do not pitch a generic AI boat.

Source notes and open assumptions

- YC structure reference: YC seed deck template emphasizes clarity, concision, problem, solution, traction/proof, model, growth, team, and ask.
- Market figures are directional: MarketsandMarkets estimates USV at \$0.82B in 2025 to \$1.59B in 2030; Fortune Business Insights uses a broader \$2.4B in 2025 to \$3.55B in 2034 estimate.
- Adoption signals: Navy MCM USV, Navy Task Force 59, Coast Guard RAS PEO, Coast Guard MDA pilots, and public funding momentum around Saronic, HavocAI, Seasats, and Saildrone.
- Unknowns to replace before sending: final company name, founder bios, prototype status, traction metrics, customer conversations, exact raise amount, and detailed use of funds.

Primary source links are in the EIR memo and Notion investor/advisor map created on 2026-05-26.